

Placement Simulator - Interview Report

Role: SDE

Category: dsa

Difficulty: easy

Scores

overall: 55/100

technical: 55/100

communication: 55/100

confidence: 60/100

problemSolving: 55/100

coding: 40/100

Strengths

- Correctly identified and explained Floyd's cycle detection algorithm for linked lists.
- Provided a concise, accurate explanation of the algorithm's time and space complexity.
- Attempted to solve the two-sum problem with a hash map approach.

Weaknesses

- Unable to answer the palindrome question, indicating a gap in string manipulation knowledge.
- The two sum implementation contains a logic error: it returns the wrong index.
- Lacked explanation or discussion of edge cases and testing for the two sum solution.

Suggestions

- Practice common string problems (palindrome, anagram, etc.) and focus on handling case and non-alphanumeric characters.
- Review the two sum algorithm to ensure the correct index is returned and test with multiple cases, including duplicates.
- Improve communication by explaining code logic and reasoning, not just presenting code.

Summary

The candidate demonstrated solid knowledge of linked list cycle detection but failed to answer a basic string problem and made a critical mistake in the two sum implementation. Communication was clear for the correct answer but lacking elsewhere. Confidence was generally high, though the lack of explanation for the buggy code suggests room for improvement in articulating reasoning.